9.2 Cast Care

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "The cast itches and I want to scratch inside it." **Objective** • New plaster cast on the forearm • Trying to push things down inside the cast	**ACTUAL** **Deficient knowledge** related to cast care as evidenced by unsafe behaviour and questions.	Before discharge, can tell you how to look after the cast.	• Teach him never to push anything inside the cast. • Teach him to keep the cast dry and give the plaster time to dry fully (24–48 hours). • Teach him to keep the arm raised and keep moving his fingers. • Teach the warning signs: pain getting worse, numbness, colour change, a bad smell or discharge.	Repeats the instructions: **goal met**.
Subjective • "The edge of the cast rubs my skin." **Objective** • Edges of the cast rough • Skin red at the edge of the cast	**ACTUAL** **Impaired comfort** related to cast pressure and itching as evidenced by reported discomfort and redness at edges.	Within 24 hours, says it feels more comfortable.	• Pad or petal the rough edges. • For itching, blow cool air from a fan into the cast. • Check the skin at the cast edges every shift.	Comfortable: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Cast is rigid • Limb swollen after the injury	**RISK** **Risk for peripheral neurovascular dysfunction** as evidenced by risk factors: constrictive cast and swelling.	Limb stays warm and pink, with normal sensation and movement.	• Check circulation, sensation and movement every hour at first, then as ordered. • Keep the limb raised. • Report signs of compression and be ready to split the cast as ordered.	Normal: **goal met**.